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Culture (OWC): [San \(FX10\)](#)

Region: Africa

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Section Title(S): The Name Relationship

Terms for relatives, then, allow every !Kung San to classify another as not being foreign and set bounds on their mutual behavior as to whether it is one of joking or respect. A San does not feel comfortable with another unless he has a term for him, for without a term of address he remains a stranger. However, although the kin terms do imply a potential relationship, there is no obligation or behavior other than joking or respect attached to them. A name relationship does not imply sharing or mutual reciprocity in itself, although it may establish the potential for such. Finally, the name relationship should not be confused with the homonymous system of applying kinship [■118](#) terminology. The latter applies to a known relative to whom a term is given by the 'factor of the name' and is a much stronger bond than a name relationship in which no underlying tie is known and a term just given from a list of names.

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*755 Prospect Street**New Haven, CT 06511*General Inquiries: [✉ hraf@yale.edu](mailto:hraf@yale.edu)Issues and Bugs: [✉ hraf-support@yale.edu](mailto:hraf-support@yale.edu)
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